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Bridging Mechanics Desk and ActiveCampaign

What connected the two systems before, what was missing, and the nightly reconciliation that now closes deals as Won or Lost.

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Bridging Mechanics Desk and ActiveCampaign

What changed on 4 September 2026, why it was needed, and how the two systems talk to each other now.

1. In one paragraph

Mechanics Desk is where quotes are written. ActiveCampaign is where the sales pipeline and marketing live. Until today the connection between them was one-directional and lossy: a quote email created or updated a deal, and after that the two systems drifted apart with nothing to reconcile them. Deals never closed, half the pipeline sat in an archive nobody was looking at, and nothing on a deal recorded where it had come from. Today's work closes that loop: every deal now says where it originated, invoices in MYOB close deals as **Quote Won**, silence closes them as **Quote Lost**, and the two halves of the pipeline have been put back in one place. The live pipeline went from a reported **\$21.2M to \$27.2M** — none of it new business, all of it work that was already ours and invisible.

2. What was in place before

2.1 Pipeline A — the quote email watcher

Live since **29 April 2026**, replacing a Zapier zap that did the same job.

Microsoft Graph webhooks watch the five sales reps' mailboxes. When Mechanics Desk emails a quote PDF, the portal:

1. Reads the attachment (`performance-estimate*.pdf`) and extracts quote number, value, customer and vehicle
2. Finds or creates the **ActiveCampaign contact**
3. Creates a new **deal**, or updates an existing open one from the last 30 days
4. Creates or updates the matching **Monday.com** board item

That much worked, and still does. Everything below is what sat *around* it.

2.2 The gaps

Gap	What it meant
No deal ever closed	Nothing marked a deal Won or Lost. The pipeline only ever grew.
No record of origin	Nothing on a deal said whether it came from Mechanics Desk or an online enquiry. Origin could only be guessed from the shape of the deal's title.
A found deal kept its stage	When a quote went out against an existing deal, the deal stayed at <i>Quote Required</i> — a stage that means "no quote yet".
Three pipelines, one of them wrong	Make and Zapier were still creating enquiry deals in the "Old Quotes" archive rather than the live pipeline.
Detail lived in free text	Vehicle and rego existed only inside the deal title, where nothing can filter or group by them and a rep can edit them away.

2.3 The three ActiveCampaign pipelines

ID	Name	Deals	Role
4	Quote Stages	5,535	Legacy, built 2020. Untouched.
5	Old Quotes	~33,000	Archive, single stage. Was still receiving live quotes.
6	New Quote Pipeline	1,902 → 2,956	The live one: Quote Required → Sent → Won → Lost

3. What was built today

3.1 Provenance — every deal says where it came from

Deals now carry four custom fields, and the contact carries a **Mechanics Desk** tag:

- **Source** — Mechanics Desk
- **MD Quote Number**
- **Vehicle**
- **Rego**

The tag is what an ActiveCampaign automation can trigger on; the fields are what a report filters by. They are written on both new quotes and repeat quotes, so older deals get marked as they are touched.

Backfilled onto 2,177 existing deals, so history is queryable too, not just what happens next.

3.2 Quote Won — from a real invoice

A quote is only *won* when the work is invoiced, so that is the trigger. Two routes, strongest first:

Route 1 — MYOB, matched by customer email. A finalised Mechanics Desk invoice is pushed to MYOB, and a MYOB customer card carries an email address. ActiveCampaign contacts are keyed on email, so this is an identity match rather than a guess:

MYOB invoice → customer card → email → AC contact → their open deal → Quote Won

Of 101 invoices in a typical week, **80 carry an email on the card** — so this route covers roughly four fifths of them.

Route 2 — Mechanics Desk, for the rest. Where the MYOB card has no email, the portal walks MD's own keys instead:

deal → quote number → md_quotes → md_invoices, matched on MD customer id + rego

Guarded three ways: the invoice must fall after the quote, within 180 days, and be worth between **0.5× and 3×** the quote. The ceiling matters — without it, invoices at 35×, 83× and 230× the quote were being matched, which is a different job on the same vehicle, not the quoted work.

3.3 Quote Lost — silence, measured properly

A deal untouched for **90 days** closes as Quote Lost. The clock runs from **last activity**, not from when the quote went out, so a deal a rep worked last week is safe and adding a note resets it.

Deals already sitting at Won or Lost are left alone, and anything the Won passes claim is excluded first — a deal invoiced on day 100 is booked as the win it is, rather than closed for going quiet.

3.4 The archive migration

The largest single finding. **1,052 open, quoted deals worth \$13,141,263** were sitting in the "Old Quotes" archive, because the Make and Zapier form automations were still writing there after the new pipeline was built. Pipeline A found those deals — its contact lookup is not pipeline-filtered — appended the quote number and updated them *in place*, leaving live work in an archive.

All 1,052 were moved into the live pipeline at **Quote Sent**, each with a note recording where it came from. Nothing else was changed: not the value, the owner, the title, or the status. Won and Lost remain the nightly sweep's decision, made on its own evidence.

Deliberately not moved: ~14,000 unquoted enquiries worth \$0 going back to 2024. Quoted deals appear in the archive only from April 2026, which gives a clean boundary — everything older is genuine archive material.

3.5 A found deal now advances to Quote Sent

Previously the stage was left alone when a quote went out against an existing deal, on the reasoning that a rep may have moved it deliberately. That holds at Quote Sent or beyond; it does not hold at *Quote Required*, which means no quote has gone out.

464 quoted deals worth \$6,050,518 were stranded there. The rule is now narrow and deliberate: **Quote Required → Quote Sent only**. A deal at any other stage is somewhere because somebody put it there, and is never overridden.

4. Where the pipeline landed

	Before	After
Deals in the live pipeline	1,902	2,956
Value at Quote Sent	\$21,234,371	\$27,185,654
Quoted deals stranded at Quote Required	464	0
Deals carrying a Source marker	0	2,177
Deals carrying a Rego field	0	1,369

None of the \$6M increase is new business. It is work that already existed, in an archive or in the wrong column.

Where the work actually comes from

Measured across 2,183 quoted deals, from the record of what Pipeline A did rather than inferred:

Origin	Deals	Share
Online enquiry, quoted later	1,399	64%
Walk-in or phone, quote written first	784	36%

Stable between 33% and 42% every month since April. Average deal value is near-identical either way, so neither channel brings bigger jobs — there is simply twice as much of the online one.

5. How it runs now

`/api/cron/ac-deal-sweep` — **18:40 UTC daily (04:40 Brisbane)**, seventy minutes after the Mechanics Desk overnight pull, so it reasons about fresh data.

Three passes in order — Won from MYOB, Won from MD, then Lost.

Turning it on and off

Settings → **Connections** → **Integrations** → **"AC deal sweep — arming"**

Setting	Effect
<code>AC_SWEEP_MYOB_WON_LIVE</code>	Arms the MYOB Won pass
<code>AC_SWEEP_WON_LIVE</code>	Arms the Mechanics Desk fallback
<code>AC_SWEEP_LOST_LIVE</code>	Arms the 90-day Lost pass
<code>AC_SWEEP_ENABLED</code>	Set to <code>false</code> to stop everything

Each pass is a **dry run** until its flag reads exactly `true`. These live in the portal rather than in Vercel deliberately: closing deals has no bulk undo, and a switch that needs a code deploy is not an emergency stop. Changes take effect within thirty seconds.

To read the numbers without changing anything, open `/api/cron/ac-deal-sweep?verbose=1` while signed in as an admin. A session login is always forced dry, whatever the flags say.

Every deal the sweep touches gets a note explaining exactly why — which invoice matched, how it was matched, and how long it had been idle. A wrong decision is always explainable rather than mysterious.

6. What to watch

- **A wave of Lost around late November.** Most migrated deals were touched in late August, so their 90-day clocks expire together.
 - **The 353 "Quote Required - Sent" placeholders.** Identical junk deals created by the retired Zapier zap between January and April. They will be swept to Lost — correct, but it will make the Lost count look large.
 - **Won will under-report at first.** It fires on invoicing, and Mechanics Desk usually stops at "job created" without advancing the quote. Expect fewer wins recorded than actually happened.
 - **Roughly 41% of MD quotes carry no rego**, and another 12% say "TBA". Those are treated as no rego at all. It is the single biggest limit on the Mechanics Desk fallback route.
 - **One unexplained deal.** Deal 42611 carried Pipeline A's own title format but was found in the archive — worth knowing whether something is moving deals out of the live pipeline.
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Compiled 4 September 2026. Technical detail — every endpoint, table and API trap behind the above — is in the Full Handover Document, §5.8.